LoLe

Brand Identity & Guidelines

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Runs your restaurant.

This document defines the visual identity, voice, and design principles for LoLe — the operating system built for modern restaurants in Ethiopia. Every design decision herein serves a single purpose: to make LoLe feel like the inevitable, trusted infrastructure layer every restaurant deserves.

01 — Brand Strategy

Mission

To give every restaurant in Ethiopia — from a neighborhood coffee house to a multi-location dining group — the same world-class operating intelligence that the best restaurants on earth enjoy.

Vision

A future where no restaurant in Ethiopia loses a sale, a customer, or an hour of productivity to broken, manual, paper-based systems.

Brand Positioning

> ***"LoLe is the silent operator behind every successful restaurant."***

LoLe occupies the infrastructure layer of the restaurant industry — not a point-of-sale tool, not a loyalty app, but the complete operating system that unifies every function of a restaurant into one intelligent, reliable platform.

Positioning statement:

FOR RESTAURANT OWNERS IN ETHIOPIA

LoLe is the all-in-one restaurant operating system that replaces fragmented, manual workflows with a unified digital platform — so owners spend less time fighting fires and more time growing their business.

Value Proposition

One platform. Every operation.

LoLe eliminates the need for separate POS hardware, paper order pads, manual cashier reconciliation, spreadsheet loyalty tracking, and disconnected marketing tools. It is one system — deployed across every touchpoint — working in silence so restaurants can focus on food and hospitality.

Core Value Pillars

Invisible Power	The platform does the heavy lifting so staff never feel the complexity.
Operational Intelligence	Real-time analytics transform gut-feel decisions into data-driven growth.
Reliability	Offline-first architecture ensures zero downtime, even when internet is unstable.
Control	Owners see every order, table, payment, and customer in one place, instantly.
Growth	Loyalty programs, digital marketing, and multi-location tools scale with the business.

Brand Story

"LoLe" comes from Amharic — it means servant or attendant. But LoLe is not a passive servant. LoLe is the intelligent, tireless system that attends to every detail of a restaurant's operation so the owner, the chef, and the team can focus on what they do best: creating exceptional experiences for guests.

When a customer scans a QR code to order, LoLe processes it. When the kitchen needs to know what's next, LoLe displays it. When a waiter deserves a tip, LoLe captures it. When an owner wants to know why Friday sales were 30% above average, LoLe explains it. The restaurant runs. LoLe makes it possible.

This is the transformation LoLe delivers: from manual service to intelligent operations.

02 — Visual Identity System

Logo Direction

The LoLe wordmark is set in a refined, geometric sans-serif with subtle customization to the letterforms. The double-L at the center of the name creates a natural visual rhythm — two vertical pillars suggesting stability, duality, and structure.

Logo Concept

Wordmark	"LoLe" in Inter Display — optically tracked, weight: SemiBold
Symbol	A minimal square with a notched corner — suggesting a smart terminal, a screen, a receipt slot. Works as app icon and favicon.
Lockup	Horizontal (primary): symbol + wordmark. Stacked (secondary): symbol above wordmark.
Clear space	Minimum 1× cap-height on all sides
Minimum size	80px wide on-screen · 24mm in print

Logo Color Variations

Primary	Wordmark in Ink (#0A0A0A) on white — default use
Green	Wordmark in Brand Green (#1A6B47) on white or mist — marketing
Reversed	Wordmark in white on Brand Green — dark backgrounds
Gold	Wordmark in Gold (#C89B3C) on Ink — premium / enterprise contexts
Monotone	Full black or full white — single-color reproduction only

Logo Do's and Don'ts

✓ DO	Use approved color variations only. Maintain minimum clear space at all times.
✓ DO	Use the reversed white version on dark backgrounds (green, slate, ink).
✗ DO NOT	Stretch, compress, rotate, or alter proportions of the logo.
✗ DO NOT	Apply drop shadows, gradients, or outline strokes to the logo.
✗ DO NOT	Place the logo on busy photography without a clean background treatment.
✗ DO NOT	Use the wordmark without the approved typeface letterspacing.

Color Palette

PRIMARY COLORS

Brand Green	Active Green	Deep Slate	Ink
#1A6B47	#22885A	#1E2D3D	#0A0A0A

ACCENT & SUPPORT

Premium Gold	Warm Mist	Stone	Steel
#C89B3C	#F5F5F0	#E8E4DC	#A0A8B0

Color Usage Rules

Brand Green	Primary brand color. Use for CTAs, key UI elements, headings, and accents. Never use as large background in UI (too dominant).
Deep Slate	Use for primary body text in long-form content, dark UI surfaces, and navbars.
Ink	Near-black for body copy, table text, and detailed UI elements.
Premium Gold	Reserve for enterprise tier, premium features, award callouts, and selected print materials. Never overuse.
Warm Mist	Default page background for all marketing surfaces. Warmer than pure white — humanizes the brand.
Steel	Secondary text, labels, captions, placeholder text, and metadata.

Typography System

Primary Typeface: Inter

Inter is the LoLe system font — chosen for its exceptional legibility on screens, its extensive weight range, and its clean geometric character that aligns with the brand's modern, infrastructure-grade personality.

Display / Hero	Inter · Bold · Size: 56–96pt · Tracking: –1%

Heading 1	Inter · SemiBold · Size: 40–48pt · Tracking: –0.5%
Heading 2	Inter · SemiBold · Size: 28–36pt · Tracking: –0.3%
Heading 3	Inter · Medium · Size: 20–24pt · Tracking: 0%
Body Large	Inter · Regular · Size: 18pt · Line height: 1.7
Body	Inter · Regular · Size: 16pt · Line height: 1.65
Caption / Label	Inter · Medium · Size: 12–13pt · Tracking: +2% · All Caps
Micro	Inter · Regular · Size: 11pt · for legal, footnotes

Secondary Typeface: Freight Display (Print Only)

For long-form editorial content, formal printed materials, and select headline treatments, Freight Display Pro (a refined serif) may be used alongside Inter. It adds warmth and elegance for premium contexts — menus, pitch decks, annual reports. Never use in the product UI.

Typographic Principles

Hierarchy	Always establish clear visual hierarchy: one dominant heading, one supporting subhead, one body level per section.
Alignment	Left-align all body text. Center-align only for short hero statements (3 words or fewer per line).
Contrast	Use weight contrast (bold vs. regular) and size contrast instead of color contrast for legibility.
Spacing	Generous line-height (1.6–1.75 for body). Tight tracking for headings (–1 to –2%). Wide tracking for labels (+2 to +4%).

Iconography Style

LoLe uses a custom icon set built on a 24×24px grid with 1.5px stroke weight. Icons are outlined, not filled — consistent with the clean, modern aesthetic of the brand.

Grid	24×24px base, 2px margin inset for optical balance
Style	Outlined / stroke · 1.5px · Rounded joins · Rounded caps
Corner radius	2px on rectangles and squares for consistency with UI corners
Color	Inherit text color in UI · Brand Green for featured states · Steel for secondary

Library	Lucide Icons (open-source) as base, with custom icons for restaurant-specific concepts

Design Principles

01 · Clarity Over Decoration

Every element must earn its place. Remove anything that does not help the user understand, decide, or act. Resist the urge to fill space with decorative patterns or gratuitous imagery.

02 · Structure Creates Trust

Restaurants trust LoLe with their livelihoods. The design must feel structured, reliable, and precise — like infrastructure, not a consumer app. Use consistent grid systems, predictable spacing, and rigorous alignment.

03 · Calm Intelligence

Complexity should feel effortless. A restaurant owner looking at their dashboard should feel in command, not overwhelmed. Use progressive disclosure to reveal depth without front-loading complexity.

04 · Warm, Not Cold

Infrastructure does not have to feel clinical. LoLe's warm mist backgrounds, rounded components, and human-first copy give the platform approachability that matches the hospitality industry it serves.

03 — Product Branding

Product Naming System

Each LoLe product module carries the "LoLe" parent brand prefix, followed by a single descriptive English word that instantly communicates the module's primary function. Names are always written in Title Case.

Product Family

LoLe POS	Waiter-facing point-of-sale tablet interface
LoLe Order	QR-code customer ordering — dine-in, takeaway, delivery
LoLe Kitchen	Kitchen Display System (KDS) for real-time order management
LoLe Cash	Cashier terminal and payment processing
LoLe Store	Online ordering storefront — customer-facing web/app
LoLe Loyalty	Customer rewards and loyalty program management
LoLe Reach	SMS and email marketing campaigns

LoLe Tip	Digital tipping system for waiters
LoLe Insight	Real-time analytics and business intelligence dashboard
LoLe Admin	Owner / manager back-office control panel

Sub-brand Structure

All product names operate under the unified LoLe umbrella. There are no independent sub-brands. The "LoLe" prefix ensures immediate brand recognition across all touchpoints and prevents product confusion as the platform scales.

Verbal	"LoLe Insight" — always spoken and written in full
Short form	Module names alone ("Insight", "Kitchen") only acceptable in product UI after initial context is established
Never	Abbreviations (LP, LK), all-caps (LOLE ORDER), or standalone brand-less names in external communications

Feature Naming Conventions

Naming style	Functional and plain English. No jargon, no invented words.
Examples ✓	"Offline Mode", "Smart Routing", "Auto Close Day", "Loyalty Balance", "QR Table Card"
Examples ✗	"OfflinePro™", "IntelliRoute", "DayClosure 2.0", "LoyaltyCoins++"
Tier labels	Starter · Growth · Scale (never "Basic / Pro / Enterprise" — too generic)

04 — UI / UX Design Direction

Interface Philosophy

LoLe's interface is inspired by the design languages of Apple, Stripe, and Notion. It is deliberate, minimal, and information-dense without feeling cluttered. Every screen answers one primary question and enables one primary action.

Layout Principles

Grid	12-column grid on desktop · 4-column on tablet · 2-column on mobile
Base unit	8px spacing system (8, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 96, 128)
Max width	1280px content container · 960px for data-heavy dashboards

Column gutter	24px desktop · 16px tablet
Section spacing	Minimum 96px between primary content sections on marketing pages

Component Style

Buttons

Primary CTA	Brand Green · White label · 10px radius · 48px height · Inter SemiBold 16px
Secondary	Transparent · Green border (1.5px) · Green label
Ghost	Transparent · Steel border · Ink label
Destructive	Red (#C0392B) fill · White label
States	Hover: 6% darkened · Active: 12% darkened · Disabled: 40% opacity

Cards & Surfaces

Background	White (#FFFFFF)
Border	1px #E8E4DC (Stone)
Radius	12px (cards) · 8px (inputs, tags) · 4px (chips)
Shadow	0 2px 8px rgba(0,0,0,0.06) · Hover: 0 4px 16px rgba(0,0,0,0.10)
Elevation levels	Level 0: no shadow (flat) · Level 1: subtle (default) · Level 2: floating (modals, dropdowns)

Data Tables (Dashboard)

Header row	Warm Mist background · Inter Medium 13px · All-caps · Steel color
Data rows	White background · Inter Regular 15px · Ink color · 52px row height
Alternating	Subtle alternating: white / mist (optional)
Borders	1px Stone horizontal dividers only — no vertical cell borders
Hover	Row highlight: Stone background on hover

Dashboard Design Direction

The LoLe Insight dashboard is designed around the metaphor of a control room — calm, information-rich, and always in control. The primary layout uses a persistent left-navigation sidebar with a fixed header bar and a main content area that updates contextually.

Sidebar	240px fixed · Deep Slate background · White icons and labels · Active state: Brand Green indicator
Header	64px · White · Business name + date range selector + user avatar
KPI cards	Row of 4–5 metric cards at top · Large number in Inter Bold · Subtext label in Steel
Charts	Recharts / Chart.js · Green primary line/bar · Stone grid lines · No chart borders
Color in data	Green = positive / primary · Gold = target / benchmark · Red = alert · Steel = secondary

05 — Brand Voice & Messaging

Tone of Voice

LoLe speaks like a trusted expert who has seen the problem from both sides — someone who understands the chaos of a busy restaurant and knows exactly what it takes to solve it. The voice is confident without being arrogant, clear without being cold, and helpful without being cheerful.

Confident	We know this works. We've built it for you. We state facts, not claims.
Clear	No jargon. No buzzwords. One idea per sentence. The smartest explanation is the simplest one.
Reliable	We say what we'll do, and we do what we say. Every word earns trust.
Respectful	We treat restaurant owners as intelligent, capable people who deserve great tools.
Direct	We do not hedge, apologize, or over-explain. We get to the point.

Messaging Principles

Lead with outcomes	Don't say "QR ordering module" — say "Customers order themselves. Your team serves more."
Specificity wins	Use real numbers when possible. "Less waiting" < "Orders in 45 seconds."
Avoid tech speak	Never use acronyms or technical terms in customer-facing copy without immediate plain-language context.
Active voice always	"LoLe syncs your menu" not "your menu is synced by LoLe."

Respect the reader	Trust that restaurant owners understand business. Don't over-explain obvious benefits.

Website Copy Examples

Hero Headline

RUNS YOUR RESTAURANT.
One platform. Every table, every order, every payment — managed in real time.

Feature Headlines

QR Ordering	"Customers order. Kitchens cook. You grow. The table takes care of itself."
Kitchen Display	"Every order, every station, every second — in perfect sync."
Analytics	"Know exactly what sold, when, and why. Every day, automatically."
Offline Mode	"Unstable internet? LoLe keeps working. Because your restaurant doesn't stop."
Loyalty	"The customers who come twice become the ones who come every week."

App Microcopy Examples

Empty state	"No orders yet. Your next sale is one scan away."
Success toast	"Order sent to kitchen." (no exclamation marks)
Error message	"Connection lost. Don't worry — LoLe saved your order. It will sync when you're back online."
Onboarding	"Set up your first menu. It takes about 5 minutes."
Confirmation	"Close the day? This will finalize all sales for 28 May."
Loading state	"Syncing your menu..." (always tell users what is happening)

06 — Marketing & Growth Design

Website Style Direction

Overall feel	Clean, minimal, editorial. Like Stripe.com — beautiful information architecture over visual noise.
Background	Warm Mist (#F5F5F0) as page background. White for cards and content sections.
Accent	Brand Green for CTAs, active states, and decorative elements.
Photography	Real Ethiopian restaurant environments. Authentic, not stock. Well-lit, natural tones.
Motion	Subtle scroll-triggered fade-ins and slide-ups. Nothing distracting.

Landing Page Structure

The LoLe marketing homepage follows a proven high-conversion structure while maintaining brand premium:

01 · Hero	Full-screen — Tagline + subheadline + primary CTA + secondary link + subtle product screenshot
02 · Social Proof	Logo strip of 4–6 known Addis Ababa restaurants using LoLe
03 · Problem Statement	"Here's what running a restaurant in Ethiopia looks like today." — honest and specific
04 · Solution Overview	The LoLe platform — animated module overview / product walkthrough
05 · Feature Deep Dives	Alternating left-right sections per key module (Order, Kitchen, Insight, etc.)
06 · ROI / Proof	"Restaurants on LoLe see X% reduction in order errors in week one." — with testimonials
07 · Pricing	Three tiers: Starter · Growth · Scale — clean comparison table
08 · Final CTA	"Start your free 30-day trial. No credit card required." — full-width Brand Green section

Social Media Style

Platform focus	Instagram (brand awareness) · LinkedIn (B2B / investor) · Telegram (Ethiopia-specific community)
Visual style	Clean product screenshots on mist backgrounds · Bold typographic posts · Real restaurant photography
Post types	Feature spotlight · Restaurant spotlight · Data insight · Tips for owners · Behind-the-scenes

Caption tone	Concise and direct. One idea per post. Strong opening line. Clear CTA when needed.
Hashtags	#LoLeRestaurant #AddisRestaurant #EthiopianHospitality — 3–5 max per post

Ad Design Direction

Digital ads	Headline in Inter Bold · Product screenshot or clean graphic · Brand Green CTA button · White / Mist background
Copy formula	Problem (5 words) → Solution (5 words) → CTA (3 words) — "Manual orders cause errors. LoLe fixes that. Start free."
Video ads	15–30 seconds · Screen recording of product flow · Amharic or English voiceover · No music overload
OOH / Print	Large wordmark · Single headline · Single QR code for demo request · Mist or green background

07 — Motion & Interaction

Animation Principles

Purpose	Every animation communicates state change or guides attention. Never decorative.
Tone	Smooth and precise. Like a well-tuned machine, not a toy.
Duration	UI micro-interactions: 100–200ms · Page transitions: 200–350ms · Onboarding: 400–600ms
Easing	ease-out for enter animations · ease-in for exit · ease-in-out for state changes
Restraint	When in doubt, animate less. Busy screens (KDS, POS) must have zero decorative animation.

Transitions

Page transitions	Fade + subtle vertical slide (8px) — consistent across all routes
Modal open	Scale from 0.96 → 1.0 + fade in · 200ms ease-out
Drawer / sidebar	Slide in from left or right · 250ms ease-out

Toast notifications	Slide in from top-right · 180ms · Auto-dismiss after 3–4s
Tab switches	Underline indicator slides smoothly between tabs · 150ms

Micro-interactions

Button press	Scale 0.97 on active · Returns to 1.0 on release — provides physical feedback
Input focus	Border color transitions to Brand Green · 150ms
Checkbox / Toggle	Smooth checked state: thumb slides · Color fills · 200ms
Card hover	Elevation increases (shadow deepens) + 2px lift · 150ms
KDS new order	Card slides in from top · Green flash border for 1.5s · Then settles to normal
Success state	Checkmark draws itself (path animation) · 400ms · Brand Green
Loading	Minimal spinner — 2px stroke · Brand Green · Never block the full screen unnecessarily

Sound Design (Optional / Future)

For the KDS and POS interfaces only: a subtle, non-disruptive audio cue (a clean, low-pitched chime) can accompany new order notifications. Must be toggleable. Default: off. Sound should never be used in customer-facing interfaces.

08 — Photography & Illustration

Photography Direction

LoLe's photography must reflect real Ethiopian restaurant life — the warmth, the energy, the craftsmanship, and the pride of the industry. Imagery should feel documentary, not staged.

Style Parameters

Color grading	Warm, natural color temperature. Slight golden-hour warmth. Avoid cold, desaturated, or over-filtered looks.
Lighting	Natural or ambient light preferred. Soft, even exposure. Avoid harsh flash or clinical lighting.
Subjects	Restaurant owners, chefs, waiters, customers — all Ethiopian — in authentic working environments.

Composition	Rule of thirds. Space for copy overlay when needed. Clean negative space on mist/warm backgrounds.
Depth of field	Moderate bokeh to separate subject from background. Not extreme blur.
Aspect ratios	16:9 for hero banners · 3:2 for editorial · 1:1 for social · 4:5 for Instagram feed

Photography Do's

- Authentic moments: staff at work, customers genuinely enjoying meals
- Beautifully composed food shots for contextual use
- Technology in use: tablets on tables, QR codes being scanned, KDS screens in kitchen
- Real restaurant spaces in Addis Ababa — local architecture and interior design
- Diverse representation of Ethiopian hospitality workers and diners

Photography Don'ts

- No generic Western stock photography — it destroys brand authenticity
- No perfectly staged "startup office" aesthetics — LoLe is a restaurant company
- No overlaid text directly on busy photography without a semi-transparent mist overlay
- No cold or blue-tinted color grading
- No photos of empty restaurants — convey life and activity

Illustration Style

When custom illustration is needed (onboarding flows, empty states, feature explainers), LoLe uses a clean, geometric flat illustration style with a warm, limited color palette derived from the brand colors.

Style	Geometric flat · No outlines (filled forms) · Warm mist and green palette
Characters	Stylized human figures representing Ethiopian restaurant workers and owners
Objects	Restaurant and technology objects: tablets, menus, plates, phones, receipts
Complexity	Simple: 3–5 shapes per element. Never over-detailed.
Color use	Brand Green as dominant · Gold as accent · Mist / Stone as backgrounds · Ink for text-in-illustration
Usage	Empty states · Onboarding steps · Marketing explainers · Never in high-density data screens